

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Ārya Vajrapāṇi Nāmāṣṭaśataka Dhāraṇī Mantra Sahita · Toh 878 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལག་ན་རྩོམ་མཛན་བར་རྒྱ་མར་དུ་པ་གཟུངས་སྒྲུས་དང་བཅས་པ།

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra, known in Tibetan as Phakpa Lakna Dorjé Tsen Gya Tsa Gyepa Zungngak Dang Chepa, is a short scripture devoted to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the fierce protector who wields the vajra. Its Sanskrit title is not securely attested, though it would correspond to something like Ārya Vajrapāṇi Nāma Aṣṭaśataka. The text opens with Vajrapāṇi proclaiming his own heart mantra, at which the earth shakes and obstructing spirits cry out in terror. The Buddha, smiling, gently urges him not to frighten the assembly too much, and Vajrapāṇi responds by praising his dhāraṇī as supremely secret and the highest of all knowledge-mantras. It is Toh 878 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts associated with the tantra section, works valued for the protective and purifying power of their recited formulas and names.

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi spoke his own heart mantra:

oṃ vajra paṇḍa sarva duṣṭāṃ ta ka ha na da ha pa ca hūṃ phaṭ

As soon as this dhāraṇī-mantra had been spoken, the great earth shook, and all the obstructors and vināyakas were terrified and let out cries of distress. Everyone gathered in the great maṇḍala also exclaimed, "Ha ha!" The gods and the other great vidyādhara also let fall a great rain of ornaments.

Then the Blessed One, smiling, looked at Vajradhara and said, "Dispeller of the hostile, do not frighten this assembly too much!"

Vajradhara replied, "Blessed One, this dhāraṇī of mine is supremely secret. It is the highest of all vidyā-mantras. It averts all obstructors, dispels all who are hostile, bestows what is sublime, and bestows wealth. It makes the hostile become pleased. If it is heard, it brings benefit; if it is recited, it brings benefit; if it is honored and venerated, it brings benefit. It generates strength, makes one's form beautiful, produces eloquence, causes one to gain sovereignty,

makes one wealthy, and brings under control. It crushes the hostile and destroys the hostile. It removes poison, brings victory, gives joy, gives supreme joy, and inspires faith. It conquers pride, defeats opponents, pacifies wrongdoing, purifies offenses that have been committed, and pacifies the afflictions such as desire. It averts the deeds of immediate retribution, pacifies bad dreams, pacifies what is inauspicious, increases glory, and brings good fortune. It delights all sentient beings, brings others under control, grants whatever is wished for, and perfects all good qualities. It thoroughly pacifies excessive rain, the failure of rain, and the harms of the seasons.

"When there is great war, great epidemic, great strife, danger from nonhumans and the like, hostility, curses, great vetāla rites, banishment, a time when one's life is in danger, or when great fear arises, one should rise at dawn, bathe, put on white clothes, face east, and, gazing at the face of the Blessed One Vajradhara, recite it seven times. By merely reciting it, one will be freed from all fears, will also attain the great accomplishment, and will be victorious everywhere. For protecting, guarding, and sheltering sentient beings, there is nothing greater than this great dhāraṇī."

Then the whole assembly, filled with wonder, praised Vajradhara with a hundred and eight names:

Vajrasattva, great being,
Vajra King, great bliss,
Vajra Terror, great delight,
Vajra Essence, of great strength,
Vajra Turmoil, great noose,
Vajra Terrifier, who strikes terror,
Vajra hūṃ, you are the hūṃ of hūṃ,
Vajra, terrifier of the underworld,
Vajra of Passion, great passion,
Noose of Passion, great swiftness,
Red-handed one, long of arm,
Red-eyed one, endowed with eyes,
Vajra Sapphire, great sapphire,
Adorned with dark-blue hair,
Blue sword, great sword,
Possessor of the blue maṇḍala,
Sapphire-eyed, blue of head,
Great radiance, shining with sapphire light,

Blue vajra, unequalled in strength,
Vajra of zeal, mighty in strength,
Wrathful vajra, great wrathful one,
Dispeller who dispels the arrogance of the wrathful,
Wrathful eyes, highly praised,
Wrathful one who dispels the obstructor clans,
Bearing a bow and bearing a noose,
With the vajra arrow you surely slay,
Bearing a club, wielding the vajra sword,
With the vajra noose you utterly crush,
Vajra wheel, great wheel,
Roaring terrifying sounds, fiercely wrathful,
Of manifold form, marked with drops,
Generating splendor, bringing renown,
Hard to bear, unbearable to touch,
You who cut off sins and obstructors,
Great fierce one, vajra wrath,
Fierce feller who strikes down,
Of unfathomable depth, gone far,
Ocean of jewels, filled with joy,
Possessing the might of the ocean and Meru,
Sublime Kailāsa, summit of Meru,
Laughing with great peals of laughter,
Whose field of action spans three countless eons,
Supreme vidyādhara, vajra-bearer,
Sovereign of the great vidyādharas,
Clad in robes of willow-green and madder-red,
Sapphire-robed, delighting in blue,
Fierce protector against rākṣasas,
Delighting in ornaments of flower garlands,
Great sun, light of the sun,
Spreading forth hundreds of rays,
Liberating protector, the Teacher,

Supreme of the supreme, worshiped by the most supreme,
Great of throat, with a throat of blue hue,
Of lovely voice and lovely face, the sublime one,

Great crown, light of the vajra,
Endowed with every excellence, pure of mind,
Possessing great wisdom, great protector,
Red wind, whose field of action reaches far,
Lord who liberates, gone to the far shore,
Free from fear, yet utterly terrifying,
Great king who bears a jewel on his crown,
Great weapon, bearing weapons of every kind,
The one great way of the three worlds,
Seer of the three, three-pointed, with three topknots,
God of desire, bearing the mark of great light,
The devourer who brings terror,
Lofty, of supreme body, three-faced,
Free of hesitation, arisen from existence,
Eternal, delighting in the stars, prospering in time,
Lunar mansion, who makes the royal line flourish,
King, great holder of mantras,
Lord over all obstructors, the wise one,
Of stainless body like beryl,
Beautiful, generating strength, of manifold strength,
Generating joy, bringing about joy,
Supreme upholder of the Three Jewels,
Great God (Śiva), great hero,
Steadfast hero, resplendent,
Great bliss, who cuts bonds,
Possessing the prowess of binding fast,
Crowned with a host of great weapons,
Delighting the hosts of vidyādhara,
Long of arm, holding a great lotus,
Lotus-born, supreme of lotuses,
Mahākāla, great bhūta,
Great fierce one, great thunderbolt,
Great wind, source of laughter,
Complete with a hundred vajra weapons,
Valiant, invincible, diligent,
Lord of the hosts of great bhūtas,
Peaceful one, lord, vajra weapon,

Shattering the peaks of crags,
Son of the Victors, of mighty form,
Adorning the maṇḍala with the vajra,
Burning with iron vajra arrows,
Purifying with vajra arrows,
Vajrāmogha, vajra sovereign,
Excellent vajra, vajra prowess,
Pure wisdom, the Great Vehicle,
Master of skillful means, great compassion,
Great vajra, the playful one,
Fair-eyed one who beholds all,
Vajra bell, with perfectly pure eyes,
Beloved friend, knower of the sacred commitments,
Great vajra, the protector,
Vajra that terrifies the underworld,
Great vajra resounding with peals of laughter,
Cluster of flowers, clear and radiant,
Pure one, son of the son of Śuddhodana,
Gentle, fortunate, and pure,
Manifold one, supreme among all gods,
Possessor of the maṇḍala of the vajra host,
With lovely vajra crest, endowed with wisdom,
Exquisitely beautiful in vajra array,
Beautiful, utterly pure,
Like the great wind at the end of an eon,
Hero who holds the great secret,
Worshiped by the supreme vidyādhara,
The secret one who speaks the secret,
Delighting the hosts of men and women,
Vajra thunder roaring a mighty roar,
Vajra chain that utterly destroys,
Vajra hook, of great delight,
Blazing vajra, greatly blazing,
Wearing robes adorned with jewels,
Adorned with incense and garlands of flowers,
With earrings at his head and bracelets fastened,
Teacher of the Buddha's doctrine,

King, equal to all the buddhas,
Maheśvara, of great renown,
Master of the maṇḍala, possessor of the maṇḍala,
Revealer of the maṇḍala of the buddhas,
With head ornament and crown bound all around,
Adorned with manifold ornaments.
Thus the protector, the vajra lord,
Is praised with these hundred and eight names.

Then Vajrāmogha said:

These hundred and eight vajra names,
Adorned with the vajra secret,
Are names that give rise to the unfailing vajra,
Turning back all hostility.
Whoever with faith keeps
These hundred and eight names
Will attain every accomplishment
And be wholly freed from all faults.
Vajrapāṇi, the mighty one,
Will always follow close behind.
Whoever, rising in the morning, recites
The great qualities of Vajrapāṇi
Will be freed from all evil
And liberated from all the lower realms.
Whoever, rising in the morning, recites
This secret mantra spoken first,
King, ministers, and townsfolk,
And relatives too will be pleased with him.
Whoever recites this supreme praise,
The whole world will come under his power;
All his evil will be exhausted,
And his life and merit will increase.
Just as he wishes, he will attain
The bliss of the sublime.
Whoever, rising in the morning,
Recites in the presence of Vajrapāṇi
Will be endowed with whatever he wishes;

Of this there is no doubt.
One who recites the hundred and eight names
Cannot be overpowered
By obstructors, by any vināyakas,
Or even by terrifying kings.
Whatever wise person
Recites the supreme hundred and eight names
Will gain beauty of form, the birth of strength,
And ever-increasing bliss.
Whoever, steadfast in observance and pure,
Recites these hundred and eight names,
In short, will attain
The bliss of flourishing good qualities.

Here ends the Hundred and Eight Names of the Noble Vajrapāṇi, together with
the dhāraṇī-mantra.

Translator's Notes

- The line rendered "Clad in robes of willow-green and madder-red" is uncertain: གྲོ་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ may mean willow leaves or braided locks, and ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ may be madder-red or a red herb; the general sense of a description of his garments is clear, but the exact image is not. In the list of benefits, གྲོ་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ has an extra ལྗང་, evidently a slip for གྲོ་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་, and is translated in parallel with the neighboring phrases.
- In the line rendered "Worshiped by the supreme vidyādhara," the Tibetan has rjed ("forget"), which makes no sense here. It has been read as mchod ("worship"). In "wholly freed from all faults," the text's nges pa ("certainty") has been read as nyes pa ("faults"). "Son of the son of Śuddhodana" presents Vajrapāṇi as a spiritual son of the Buddha. The text spells log 'dren as "logs 'dren"; it is taken as vināyaka.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of

stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.